

Standard Operating Procedure: Staff Leave Application

SAMPLE DOCUMENT: fictional content created for a hackathon demonstration only.

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Owner:	Human Resources Division
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Applies to:	All permanent and contract staff

1. Purpose

This SOP explains how staff apply for leave and how each application is approved, so that every request is handled in the same way.

2. Leave entitlements

Annual leave: 20 working days per calendar year for staff with less than 10 years of service, and 25 working days per year for staff with 10 years of service or more.

Sick leave: up to 14 days per year. A medical certificate (MC) is required for an absence of 2 or more consecutive days.

Emergency leave: up to 3 days per year, for urgent family or personal matters.

Maternity leave: 98 consecutive days. **Paternity leave:** 7 days.

3. How to apply for annual leave

Step 1. The staff member submits the request through the HR portal at least **7 working days** before the leave starts.

Step 2. The direct supervisor approves or rejects the request within **3 working days**.

Step 3. HR confirms the request and updates the leave balance within **2 working days** after the supervisor approves.

Step 4. The staff member receives a confirmation email from the HR portal.

Leave of more than 5 consecutive working days also needs the approval of the Head of Department.

4. Emergency leave

The staff member must phone the direct supervisor within **2 hours** of the start of the working day. The leave must then be entered in the HR portal within **2 working days** after returning to work.

5. Sick leave

The staff member must inform the supervisor on the same day. The medical certificate must be submitted to HR within 2 working days after returning to work.

6. Carry forward of annual leave

A maximum of **5 days** of unused annual leave may be carried forward to the next year. Carried-forward days must be used by **31 March**, otherwise they are forfeited.

7. Records and contact

HR keeps all leave records for 5 years. For help, contact the HR helpdesk at hr.helpdesk@agency.example.